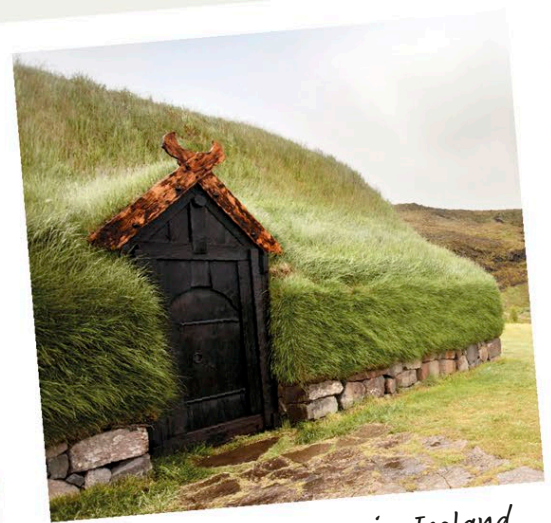


The Vikings

From the 8th to the 11th centuries CE, the Vikings set off from Scandinavia to attack, trade, and settle in new lands. They sailed along the rivers of Russia to the Black Sea, and out into the North Sea and North Atlantic. They settled in the Faroe Islands, Iceland, and Greenland and became the first Europeans to reach America. In Britain, they conquered an area that the English called the Danelaw.



A rebuilt longhouse in Iceland

Longhouse

A typical Viking home was a longhouse. It had one big shared room with a fire in the middle for warmth, cooking, and light. People slept on benches around the sides. Animals lived in a separate area at one end of the house.

ICELAND



ATLANTIC OCEAN

KEY (890–1050)

-  **Viking homelands**
The areas in Scandinavia the Vikings came from.
-  **Gains abroad**
The areas that were taken by the Vikings.
-  **Viking voyages**
The Vikings went on many voyages in their longships.
-  **Battles and raids**
The Vikings fought other people across Europe.
-  **Settlements**
Places where the Vikings settled down and had families.

GREENLAND



Eric the Red

Eric the Red founded the first Viking settlement in Greenland in 985 CE.



Leif Erikson sailed to North America around 1000 CE. He named the place he found Vinland.



Leif Erikson

VINLAND

SCALE

0 500 miles
0 500 kilometers

Across the sea

The Vikings sailed all around Europe and the Mediterranean, across Russia, the North Sea, and the North Atlantic.



Longships

Voyages were made in double-ended oak ships, with single square sails. Ships were so important to the Vikings that rulers were buried in them. This beautiful ship was found in a grave in Norway.

The Oseberg Ship